Literature Review

PortfolioGenie — Review of Existing Portfolio and Website-Building Solutions

1. Introduction

A developer portfolio is a personal website or curated online profile used to present technical skills, selected projects, experience, and contact information. For junior developers, a portfolio can help communicate practical ability when professional experience is limited. This review considers existing approaches to publishing personal websites and building websites visually, then identifies a focused opportunity for PortfolioGenie.

2. Review Method

The review uses publicly available official product pages as the starting point. The comparison focuses on the workflow relevant to this project: ease of setup, customization, coding knowledge, preview/publishing workflow, and AI-assisted writing. Product capabilities and plan limits may change, so the official documentation should be checked again before final submission.

3. Existing Solutions

3.1 GitHub Pages

GitHub Pages is a hosting service for static websites that can be used for personal, project, or organization sites. It is relevant to developers who are comfortable working with repositories and website files. It provides a route to publishing a portfolio, but the user is generally responsible for creating and maintaining the site's content and design.

Official source: https://pages.github.com/

3.2 Wix

Wix provides visual website-building tools and templates for creating different kinds of websites. This approach can reduce the amount of manual coding required and gives users a visual way to arrange page content. It is a useful reference for guided website creation and visual customization.

Official source: https://www.wix.com/

3.3 Framer

Framer provides visual design and website publishing capabilities. It is relevant to the design-first workflow of selecting layouts, refining presentation, and publishing a website. It offers a useful point of comparison for the relationship between editing and previewing a final page.

Official source: https://www.framer.com/

4. Comparative Analysis

Criterion	GitHub Pages	Wix	Framer	PortfolioGenie Focus

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Primary approach	Static-site hosting	Visual website builder	Visual design and publishing	Guided portfolio creation
Coding required	Often requires website files or a static-site workflow	Can be used with limited coding	Can be used with a visual workflow	Aim to minimize coding for portfolio creators
Customization	Depends on the site implementation	Template and visual editing options	Visual design controls	Portfolio fields and reusable layouts, subject to implementation
Preview workflow	Depends on development/publishing workflow	Visual editing and preview tools	Design and preview workflow	Live preview while editing is a core project goal
AI writing support	Not the core purpose of the hosting service	Check current product features and plans	Check current product features and plans	AI-assisted biography and project-description improvement is in the project brief
Best comparison lesson	Developer-controlled publishing	Accessible site creation	Design-led editing	Combine a focused developer workflow with guided entry and live preview

5. Findings

- Existing products demonstrate different ways to publish websites: developer-controlled hosting, visual website building, and design-first publishing.
- A junior-developer-focused workflow can be made clearer by asking for portfolio information in small, ordered steps.
- A live preview can help users understand how their entered content will appear before they share the portfolio.
- AI writing suggestions may help users improve clarity, but users should retain control and be able to edit or reject generated text.
- Accessibility, responsive layouts, and clear content structure should be considered throughout the design process.

6. Identified Opportunity

PortfolioGenie will focus specifically on junior developers rather than attempting to be a general-purpose website builder. Its proposed value is a guided multi-step portfolio form, an editor connected to a live preview, and optional AI-assisted improvements to biographies and project descriptions. This is a project positioning statement, not a claim that existing products lack these capabilities; a final claim of uniqueness would require a more detailed feature-by-feature review.

7. Conclusion

The reviewed solutions provide useful reference points for publishing and designing websites. PortfolioGenie can use these lessons to create a focused, beginner-friendly portfolio workflow. The project should prioritize accurate user input, simple navigation, accessible responsive design, and transparent AI assistance.

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8. References

- GitHub Pages. Official website. https://pages.github.com/ (Accessed 18 October 2026).
- Wix. Official website. https://www.wix.com/ (Accessed 18 October 2026).
- Framer. Official website. https://www.framer.com/ (Accessed 18 October 2026).
- W3C Web Accessibility Initiative. Introduction to Web Accessibility. https://www.w3.org/WAI/fundamentals/accessibility-intro/
- Google Search Central. SEO Starter Guide. https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/seo-starter-guide

Note: This is an initial product-focused literature review using official public sources. If DEPI requires peer-reviewed academic papers, add relevant papers from Google Scholar or a university library and cite their authors, year, title, publication, and DOI/URL.

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